

VNR Snapshots: Key Messages and Emerging Trends

Each one-page factsheet presents a structured, comparable analysis of a country's sustainable development priorities and how they have evolved since its previous Voluntary National Review (VNR).

This is a draft document prepared for consultation and review. The content is subject to revision and should not be cited or circulated as a final version.

Methodological Approach

19 COUNTRIES COVERED: Algeria · Burkina Faso · Burundi · Cabo Verde · Cameroon · DRC · Egypt · Gabon · Guinea · Guinea-Bissau · Liberia · Malawi · Mozambique · Rwanda · Senegal · Somalia · Tanzania · Togo · Tunisia

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Source Material

Factsheets draw on two primary sources: (i) the 2026 VNR Key Messages submitted by participating African Member States to the HLPF, and (ii) each country's most recent previous VNR Key Messages. Analysis used the original language of submission to preserve intent, terminology, and framing across both cycles.

2

Thematic Analysis — Section 1: Six SDG Themes

A qualitative review of the 2026 and previous Key Messages identified six priority sustainable development themes per country — selected by prominence, strength of supporting evidence, and relevance to the SDGs. Each was given a concise title, mapped to the most relevant SDG, and paired with a synthesized narrative.

3

Thematic Analysis — Section 2: Assessment of Thematic Continuity

The six 2026 themes were compared against the country's most recent previous VNR to assess how priorities, policy emphasis, and narratives have evolved across cycles:

- **Sustained** — the priority remains substantively consistent and continues to feature prominently in national policy.
- **Evolved** — the priority has been reframed, expanded, or adapted to changing contexts or new strategic priorities.

These describe patterns of continuity and change, not assessments of progress or performance.

4

Concept Heatmap

Key policy concepts were extracted from both cycles through qualitative content analysis and grouped into four categories: Economic & Fiscal Development, Governance & Institutions, Social & Human Capital, and Climate & Environment. The most frequent are shown as a heatmap, with color intensity reflecting frequency.

Quality Assurance

All classifications, continuity assessments, SDG mappings, and concept labels were reviewed against the original submission. The methodology was applied consistently across all factsheets to ensure comparability while preserving national context.

The VNR fact sheets were prepared by the Intergovernmental Support Team (IGS) of the United Nations Office of the Special Adviser on Africa (OSAA). Compilation and analysis were undertaken by Omotola Bamidele, with contributions from Kounady Ouattara, under the guidance of Utku Teksoz. For further information please contact Mr. Utku Teksoz at teksoz@un.org

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